

LCD remote control

Silver PAC 5500 Universal Remote Control comes with a 4.3 inch LCD display and Windows SideShow technology

iPods in the deep

Swimman has worked on the iPod Shuffle by waterproofing it and enabling its use up to 25 feet below water

HTC Touch 2

Small and elegant

When you first take the Touch 2 in your hand, it looks like an impressive little gadget with a lot of promise. The gunmetal matte finish on its plastic body looks elegant. WinMo, even in the latest 6.5 flavour is bound to put off most people, but HTC's own TouchFLO UI augmentation makes this phone more usable. The phone is fast and we found the scrolling shortcut bar at the bottom of the home screen to be quite handy for quickly launching certain applications. Getting into deeper options within the phone is still a pain. Those familiar with WinMo

will find it an improvement but someone not so adept will have a hard time performing simple tasks. The resistive screen, although nice looking, is not very responsive to finger input. The dedicated hardware keys will come of use. The camera is not very impressive either. It distinctly had trouble handling different lighting conditions, resulting in a sepia-like colour tone in many shots. The inbuilt GPS and preloaded applications such as Facebook, YouTube and Office Mobile definitely earns the phone some points. We find the price tag to be tad on the outer side. HTC has better offering around that price point.

Specifications

Processor: Qualcomm MSM7225 528 MHz
Screen: 2.8-inch QVGA
Network: 850/900/1800/1900 MHz; **Memory:** 512 MB ROM; 256 MB RAM; **Weight:** 110 g; **Connectivity:** Bluetooth, Wi-Fi, 3.5-mm audio

Contact

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Price: Rs. 24,490 (MH & MP), Rs. 22,490 (Rest of India)

7/10

Features.....8
 Performance6
 Build quality.....9
 Value for money.....6

Samsung 40-inch LED TV

Sleek... needs something more

Specifications

Screen size: 40-inches,
Resolution – 1920 x 1080p, LED-backlit, Contrast ratio – 30,00,000:1 (Dynamic, stated), weight (with stand) – 23.2 kgs

Contact

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Price: Rs. 1,25,000

6/10

Features.... 6.5
 Performance6
 Build quality.....8
 Value4

The extra wide bezel of this 40-inch HDTV not withstanding, it's a quite a stunner. Thanks to LED backlighting, the display is really slim and the large stand is made of glass embedded with red highlights – Bordeaux style. The material used imparts a very upmarket look and feel. Even while setting up, the blackness level is pretty good and the HDMI ports face sideways, which really makes setting up easy.

The contrast ratio is very good, in DisplayMate, we got great scores for the grey-scale intensity check. Colour rendition was good, but we felt the gamut for red should have been a bit



wider. Movies are pretty good, with minimal banding. There is a lot of noise and banding in really dark areas of the screen while watching video content, but this is not very serious. There were some really bad issues with the backlight response and this spoilt what could have been a decent gaming experience.

There is noticeable input lag as well, noticeable in games and with desktop use. Text clarity, when connected to a PC is also an issue. Priced at Rs. 1,25,000, this Samsung 40-incher is overpriced. However, it's stunningly good looking and will make a flaunt-worthy addition to your designer home.